



LOOKING CLOSER

Staring up at the towering skeletons of dinosaurs can make you feel tiny. But bones alone do not give the whole picture of a living, breathing dinosaur. What color was the dinosaur when it was alive? How strong were its muscles, and how big were its heart and lungs? Looking closely at animals alive today gives us useful clues about features, such as the skin color of dinosaurs. We can even imagine what their insides may have looked like!



Heavyweight or lightweight?

Barosaurus was a very heavy sauropod, like *Brachiosaurus*. Sauropod means “reptile foot.” Both dinosaurs had hollow bones in their spines. This was a useful weight-saving device.

Brachiosaurus started absorbing nutrients from its food in its long, coiled, small intestine.

Brachiosaurus's heart nestled underneath its lungs. It must have had very high blood pressure for the heart to be able to pump blood all around its body.

Two massive lungs fit snugly inside its ribcage.

Bacteria in the large intestine helped this big plant-eater to digest tough plant fiber.

Tough food was broken down inside the thick walls of the stomach.

Powerful tail muscles made it possible to swing this bulky tail.

